

SEBASTIAN GROSSBERGER VILLARROEL

Senior QA Engineer | Manual & API Testing | Production Support Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior QA Engineer with 6+ years of hands-on experience in manual testing, API validation, and end-to-end workflow testing across SaaS, web, and customer-facing platforms. Proven expertise diagnosing and triaging production issues in live environments, validating REST APIs with Postman, performing backend data validation with advanced SQL, and documenting defects in Jira. Strong collaborator with Client Support, Product, Engineering, and GTM teams to resolve client-impacting incidents within SLA. Experienced in Agile/Scrum environments, regression testing, accessibility validation (WCAG), and release validation. Currently teaching QA at Universidad Fidelitas. Available for full-time work across U.S. time zones (PST, MST, CST, EST).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Manual Testing • End-to-End Testing • Regression Testing • Functional Testing • Exploratory Testing
REST API Testing (Postman) • Backend Integration Testing • SQL Data Validation • MongoDB / NoSQL Validation
Production Issue Triage • Incident Reproduction • SLA Management • Root Cause Analysis • Browser DevTools Debugging
Jira Defect Documentation • Test Case Design • Test Plan Authoring • Release Validation
Agile / Scrum • Cross-functional Collaboration • WCAG Accessibility Testing • CI/CD Release Validation
Log Monitoring (Datadog) • Kafka Async Workflow Validation • SaaS Platforms • Salesforce Integration Testing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior QA Engineer

Nitel | San Jose, Costa Rica | Oct 2024 – Present

- **Diagnose, triage, and resolve production issues** in a live SaaS platform with Salesforce integrations, ensuring SLA compliance and high client satisfaction across U.S. time zones.
- **Perform end-to-end manual testing** of complex business workflows spanning web UI, REST APIs, and backend integrations, validating data accuracy and cross-system consistency.
- **Validate REST APIs with Postman**, verifying request/response payloads, status codes, authentication, and edge cases for backend integrations.
- **Execute SQL queries (joins, subqueries, aggregations)** for backend data validation, troubleshooting data inconsistencies, and verifying test results in production-like environments.
- **Document defects, test results, and workflow issues in Jira**, providing clear reproduction steps, evidence (logs, network traces, screenshots), and business impact analysis.
- **Investigate frontend and network issues using browser developer tools** (Chrome DevTools, network tab, console logs) to isolate root causes across UI, API, and data layers.
- **Collaborate with Engineering, Product, and Support teams** in Agile/Scrum ceremonies, sprint planning, and release validation activities.

- **Designed regression test suites** and automated 150+ critical-path test cases (Cypress/Playwright) to ensure platform stability after releases.

QA Engineer / QA Squad Lead

The Lifetime Value Company (LTV) | San Jose, Costa Rica | 2020 – Sep 2024

- **Led two QA squads (Email & Flow)** in a high-traffic consumer SaaS platform, mentoring 2 junior engineers into leadership roles and improving testing efficiency by 30%.
- **Performed manual functional, regression, smoke, and exploratory testing** across web and mobile applications, validating end-to-end user workflows and business requirements.
- **Validated REST API endpoints using Postman** for backend services and third-party integrations, designing reusable collections and environment variables for repeatable testing.
- **Executed advanced SQL queries** (joins, subqueries, window functions) to validate backend data, troubleshoot user-reported issues, and verify ETL outputs.
- **Validated asynchronous workflows** including Kafka-based event streams and MongoDB collections to ensure data consistency across distributed services.
- **Documented defects and test outcomes in Jira** with structured templates (severity vs. priority), reducing defect resolution time by 30%.
- **Performed accessibility checks aligned with WCAG standards** using browser tooling (Lighthouse, axe) — contrast ratios, keyboard navigation, alt text, and ARIA attributes.
- **Partnered with DevOps to embed quality gates in CI/CD pipelines**, contributing to release validation activities and zero critical production incidents over 6 months.
- **Conducted performance testing with JMeter**, identifying bottlenecks and validating response times under load.

University Professor — Software Quality Assurance

Universidad Fidelitas | San Jose, Costa Rica | Jan 2023 – Present

- **Teach undergraduate courses** on QA methodologies, SDLC, Agile/Scrum practices, manual testing, and test automation (Python/Selenium).
- **Designed practical workshops** covering test case design, bug reporting standards, API testing with Postman, and accessibility fundamentals.
- **Mentored 400+ students through 1:1 sessions and code reviews**, achieving a 90% job placement rate for active participants.

QA Analyst (Apprentice)

Pernix | San Jose, Costa Rica | 2019 – 2020

- **Executed manual regression, functional, responsive, and performance testing** achieving 80% coverage on assigned modules and reducing manual execution time by 50% through targeted automation.
- **Created detailed test case documentation and defect reports** with clear reproduction steps and evidence to support development teams.
- **Identified security vulnerabilities** through exploratory testing, improving overall application robustness.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Manual Testing: Functional, Regression, Smoke, Exploratory, End-to-End, UAT, Risk-based Testing, Cross-browser/Cross-device

API Testing: Postman (collections, environments, scripting), REST APIs, SOAP, JSON/XML validation, SoapUI

Databases: SQL, MongoDB / NoSQL, MySQL, PostgreSQL

Defect & Test Management: Jira, Zephyr Scale, TestRail, Confluence

Monitoring & Debugging: Datadog (logs, monitoring), Chrome DevTools, network analysis, browser console debugging

Async & Distributed Systems: Kafka (event streams, consumer/producer validation), asynchronous workflow validation

Accessibility: WCAG, DevTools, Lighthouse, keyboard navigation, contrast validation

Test Automation: Playwright, Cypress, Selenium WebDriver.

CI/CD & DevOps: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, deployment validation, release validation, quality gates

Performance Testing: JMeter (load, stress, response time analysis)

Programming & Scripting: Python (advanced), JavaScript / TypeScript (advanced), SQL (advanced), Java / C# (familiar)

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Shift-Left Testing, TDD, BDD

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Advanced)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of IT Management

Tecnológico de Costa Rica (TEC)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Scrum Foundation Professional Certificate (SFPC™) — Certiprof, 2024
- Cybersecurity Awareness Professional Certificate (CAPC) — Certiprof, 2024
- Salesforce Trailhead — 33+ badges (Security, Marketing Cloud, Platform Fundamentals)